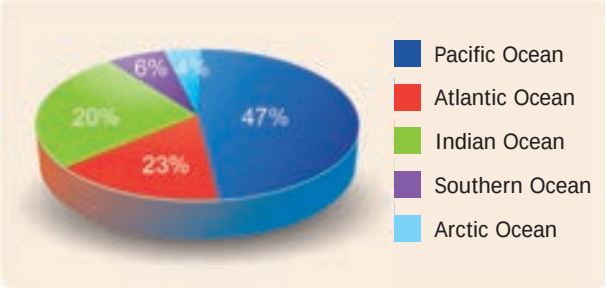
4. Oceans

The Earth looks blue when we see it from space. This is because, two-thirds of it is covered by water. The water is found in oceans and seas. Oceans are vast expanse of water. Seas are water bodies partially or fully enclosed by land. As you have studied previously, there are five main oceans in the world.



Area of Oceans (%)

4.1 The Pacific Ocean

The Pacific Ocean is the **largest and deepest ocean** on the Earth. It covers about one-third of the Earth's total area and spreads for about 168.72 million sq.km**.** It is bounded by Asia and Australia in its west and North America and South America in its east. It stretches from the Arctic Ocean in the north to the Southern Ocean in the south.



Pacific Ocean and its Marginal Seas



If **Mount Everest**, which is the highest peak (8,848 metres) was placed into the **Mariana Trench**, still there would be 2,146 metres of water left.

The depth in metres from the Mean Sea Level is denoted as **m^-**.

This ocean's shape is roughly triangular with its apex in the north at the Bering Strait which connects the Pacific Ocean with the Arctic Ocean. The Bering Sea, the China Sea, the Sea of Japan, Tasman Sea and the Philippine Sea are some of the marginal seas of the Pacific Ocean. Indonesia, Philippines, Japan, Hawaii, New Zealand are some of the islands located in this Ocean. The deepest point **Mariana Trench** is 10,994 m^- and is located in the Pacific Ocean. A chain of volcanoes is located around the Pacific Ocean called the **Pacific Ring of Fire.**



The Spanish navigator **Ferdinand Magellan** named the ocean **Pacific**, meaning calm or tranquil.